

WORK VEHICLE SAFETY AUDIT CHECKLIST

**A mid-year self-assessment for
any organization with employees
behind the wheel.**

If your team drives for work, whether that's a service van, a delivery truck, a construction site shuttle, or a sales rep's sedan, this is likely the riskiest activity happening in your operation today. According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics, transportation incidents have been the leading cause of workplace fatalities in the U.S. for more than a decade.

This checklist isn't CMV-specific. It applies to any fleet, any vehicle type, any industry. Work through each section, check what's current, and flag what needs attention before someone else flags it for you.



01



1. DRIVER RECORDS

- ☐ All drivers have a current, valid license on file
- ☐ License classifications match the vehicles drivers actually operate
- ☐ Motor Vehicle Records (MVRs) have been pulled within the last 12 months
- ☐ MVRs are reviewed for new violations, suspensions, or points
- ☐ A process exists for drivers to self-report license status changes
- ☐ Expired or downgraded licenses trigger an immediate review, not a quarterly one

02



2. VEHICLE INSPECTION LOGS

- ☐ Pre-trip and/or post-trip inspections are documented for every vehicle in use
- ☐ Inspection logs are dated, signed, and retained per your retention policy
- ☐ Defects noted on inspection logs are tracked through to repair or resolution
- ☐ Vehicles with open safety defects are taken out of service until resolved
- ☐ Inspection frequency matches vehicle type and usage (daily, weekly, per-trip)
- ☐ Spot-checks confirm logged inspections match actual vehicle condition

03



3. DRIVER TRAINING DOCUMENTATION

- ☐ Every driver has completed initial safety training before operating a vehicle
- ☐ Training completion is documented with date, content covered, and driver signature
- ☐ Refresher training is scheduled on a defined cycle (annual, biennial, etc.)
- ☐ Training records are stored somewhere retrievable, not just remembered
- ☐ New hires and transfers are trained before their first solo trip
- ☐ Training content reflects current vehicle types, routes, and known risk areas

04



4. DISTRACTED DRIVING POLICY STATUS

- ☐ A written distracted driving policy exists
- ☐ The policy has been reviewed or updated within the last 12 months
- ☐ The policy covers phone use, navigation systems, eating, and other common distractions
- ☐ Drivers have signed acknowledgment of the policy
- ☐ Violations of the policy have a defined consequence process
- ☐ The policy is enforced consistently, not just posted somewhere



05



5. INCIDENT REPORTING RECORDS

- ☐ A clear process exists for reporting any incident, near-miss, or collision
- ☐ Reports are filed promptly and consistently, not just for major incidents
- ☐ Each report includes root cause review, not just a description of what happened
- ☐ Corrective actions from past incidents are tracked to completion
- ☐ Incident trends are reviewed periodically to catch recurring issues
- ☐ Records are retained and organized well enough to survive an audit request



06



6. DOT/FMCSA FILING CURRENCY

- ☐ All required DOT/FMCSA filings are current and accurate
- ☐ Filing deadlines are tracked on a calendar, not from memory
- ☐ Recent filings have been reviewed for accuracy before submission
- ☐ Any prior violations or audit findings have documented corrective actions
- ☐ A designated person owns compliance filing responsibility
- ☐ Filing history is organized well enough to hand over to an auditor with notice



Note: DOT/FMCSA filing requirements apply to operators of commercial motor vehicles as defined by federal regulations. If your fleet does not meet CMV thresholds, confirm your specific obligations with your legal or compliance team before using this section.



How to Use This Checklist

Go section by section. Anything unchecked is a gap, and every gap is either a training issue, a documentation issue, or both. This is meant to take an afternoon, not a committee.

Next step: If this surfaced more gaps than you'd like to admit, Atlantic Training's [Driver Safety Courses](#) are built to close exactly these kinds of gaps, fast.